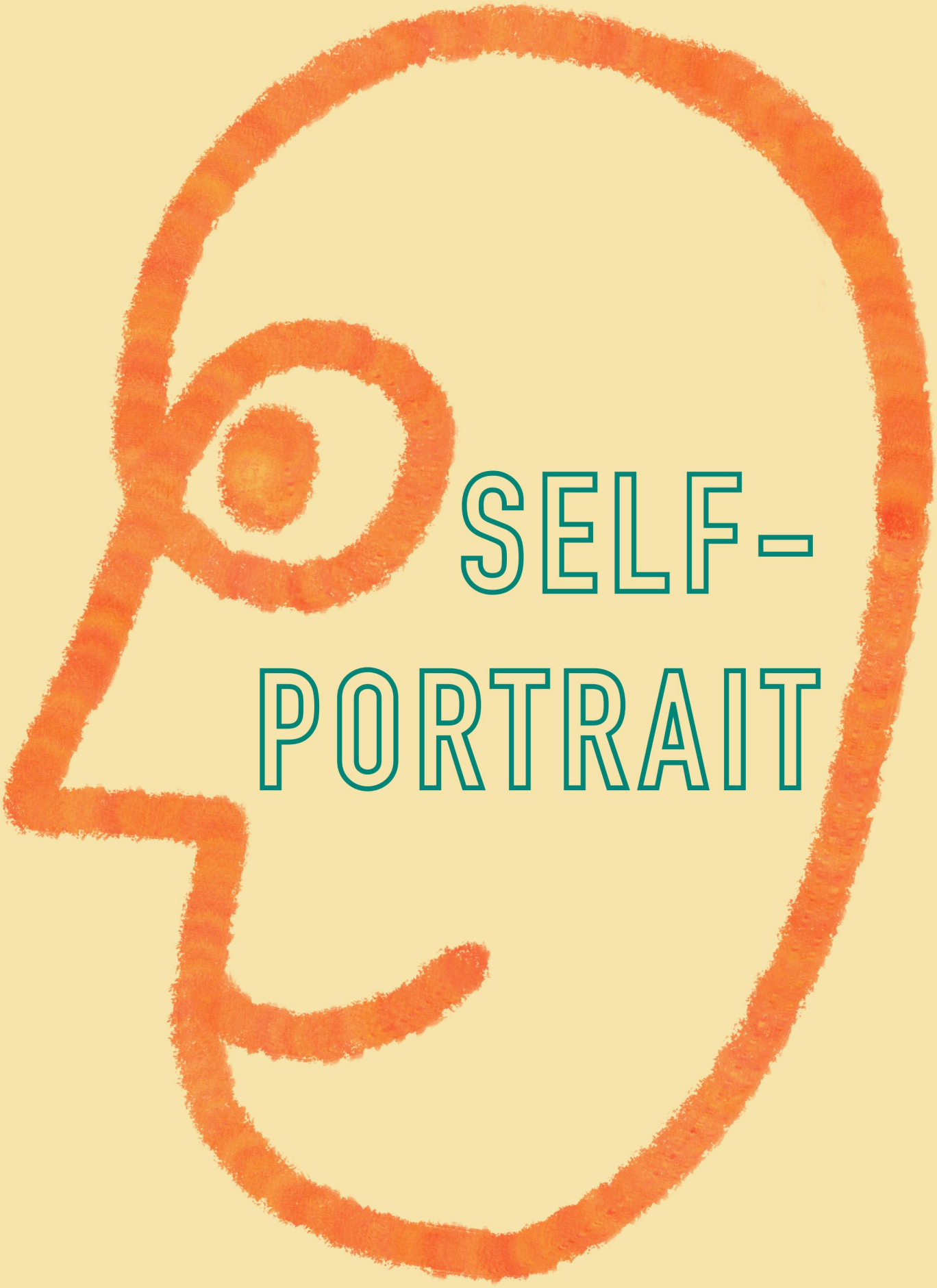

SELF-
PORTRAIT

SELF-PORTRAIT

A portrait is the representation of the image of a person through the use of drawing, painting, sculpture, photography or other kind of art.
The portrait usually covers from the shoulders to the top of the head, but sometimes takes the whole upper part of the body or even the whole body.
A ***self-portrait*** is a portrait of yourself.

In the History of Art, artists have used self-portrait over and over to practice their skills, improve their technique and experiment with new ways of representing reality.
When you look at a self-portrait, you can learn a bit more about that artist, his/her life and personality.

There are many different ways of creating a self-portrait, depending on the medium and technique to use.
In this practice, we are going to use drawing and painting to create our self-portrait.

HOW TO CREATE A SELF-PORTRAIT

Materials

To create your self-portrait you will need the following materials:

- A ***mirror:*** where you can look at yourself while working in your drawing or painting. Instead of a mirror, you can use a ***photography of yourself.***
- ***Pencil and eraser***
- ***Colors:*** color pencils or watercolor or markers or crayons or pastels or tempera paint or acrílico paint.

Steps

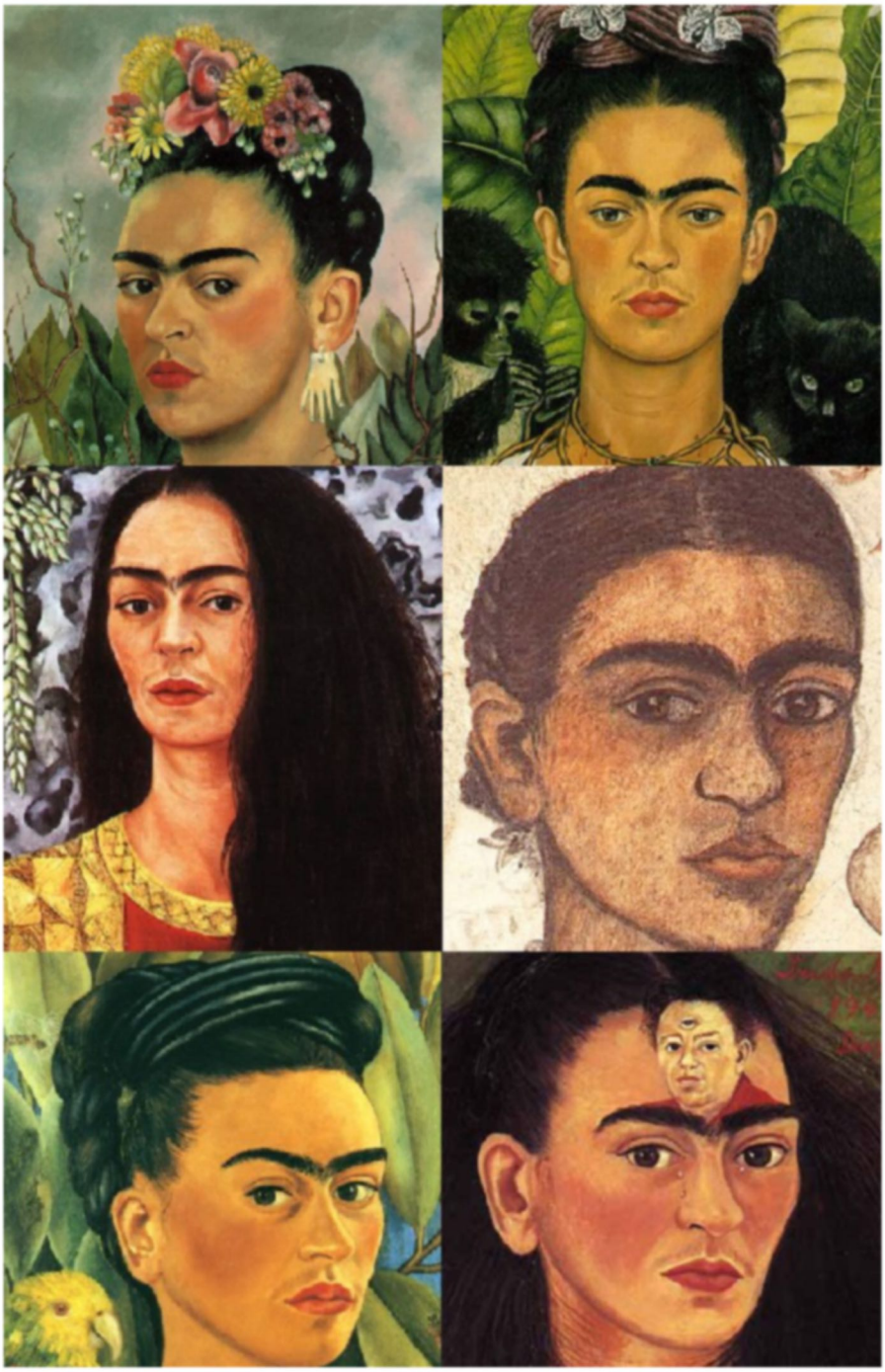
Take the mirror, the paper nd the pencil and start drawing what you see.
Give attention to the details: the shape of your eyes, nose and mouth.
Try to capture the characteristics that define you physically as unique.
You are going to create a series of ***at least 3 self-portraits.***
Each self-portrait has to be made with a different technique.
You can choose the 3 techniques and materials that you prefer!
For example:

- 1 self-portrait drawn with pencil
- 1 self-portrait painted with watercolor
- 1 self-portrait painted with crayons

You can do the three self-portraits in the same pose or you can change every time. You can even wear different clothes or complements!
And, of course, if you want to create more than 3... go for it!!

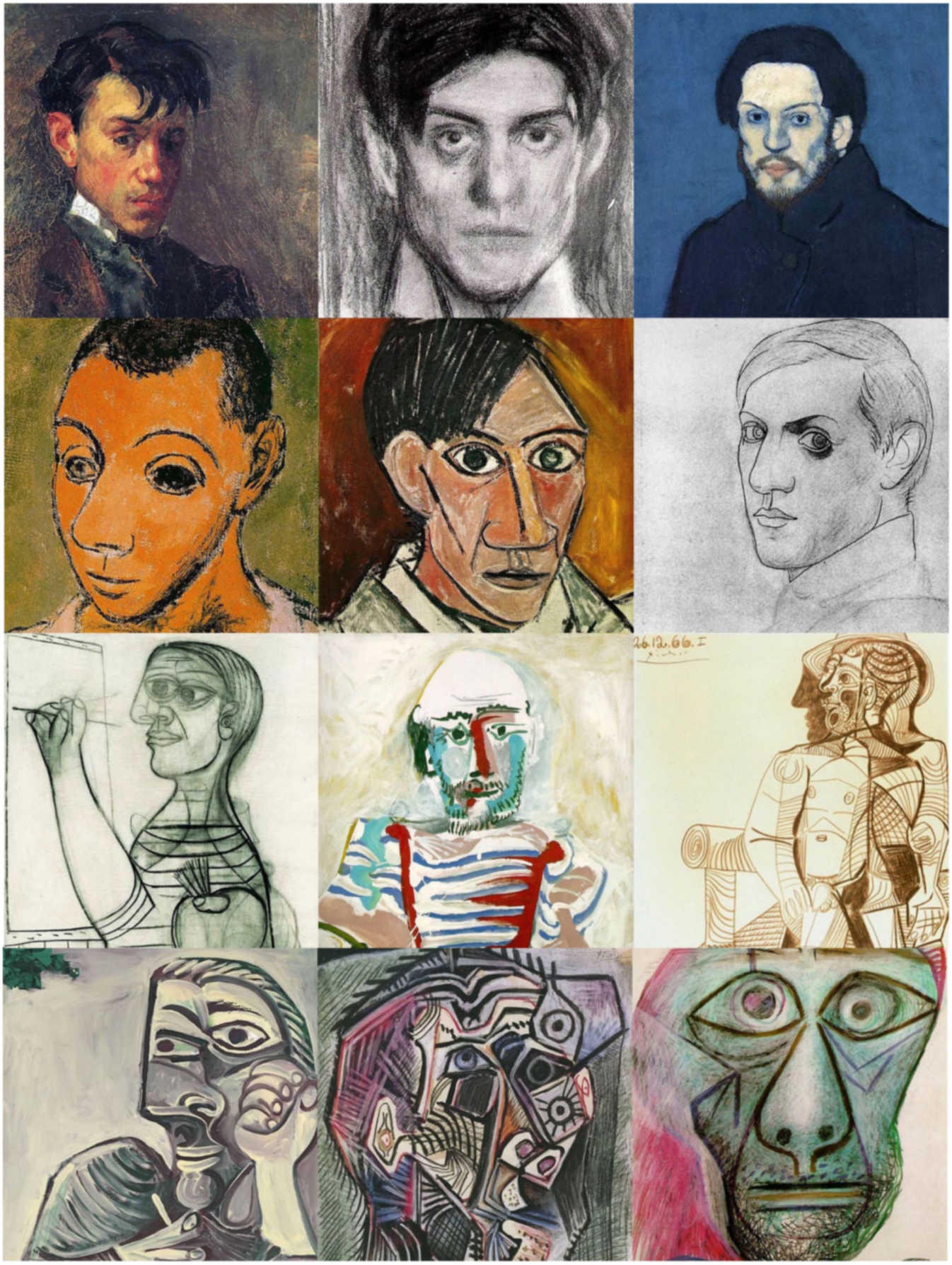
In these next pages you can see several examples of self-portraits from four famous artists. You can observe how different and unique each of them looks like compare to the others.
Look at the variety in the style and the way of using the materials to express their personal vision of themself.

Have a lot of fun!



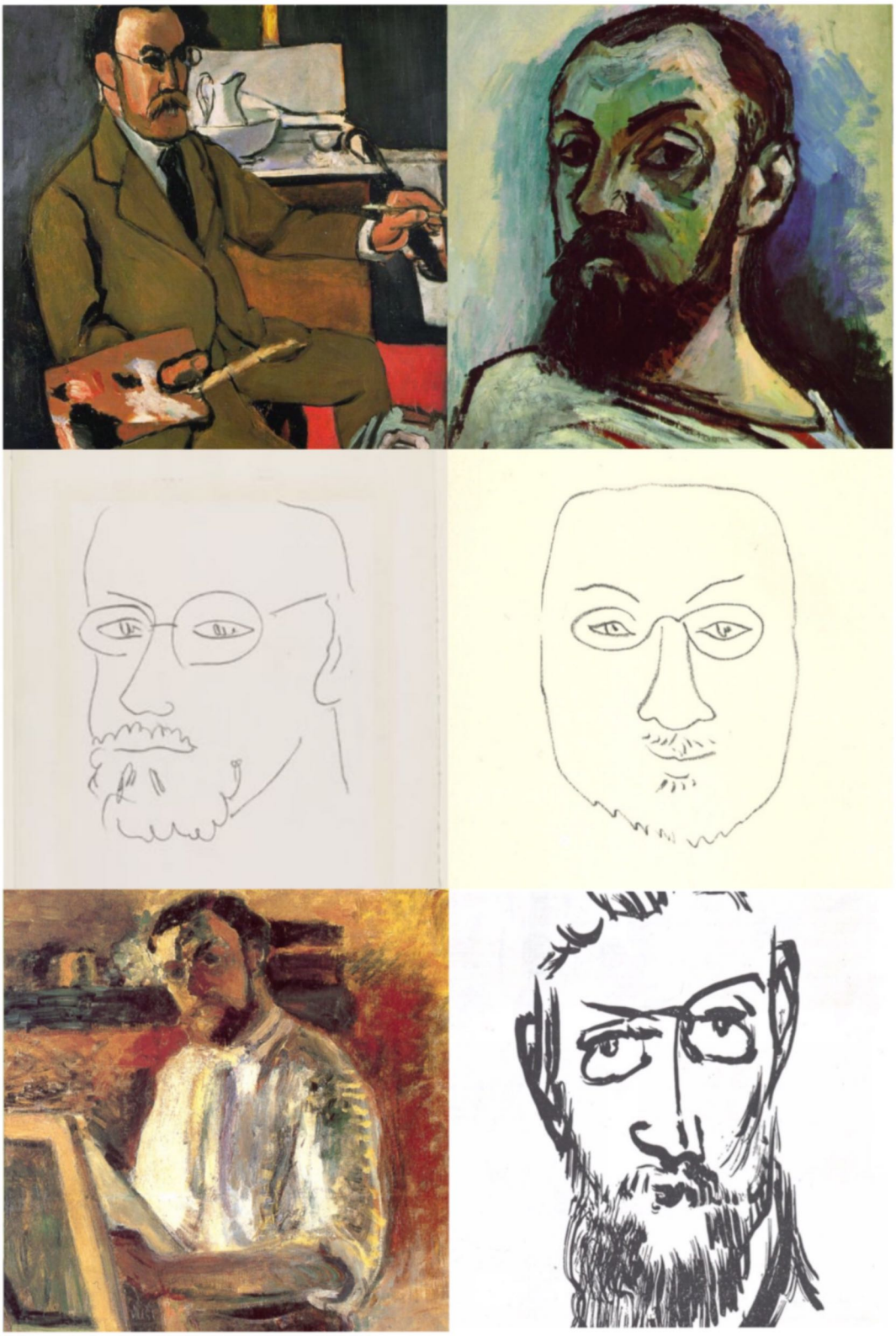
Frida Kahlo (1907-1954)

Frida Kahlo's work talks about her life and experiences (this is call auto biographic work) and she appears in most of her paintings.



Pablo Picasso (1881-1973)

Looking at Pablo Picasso's self portraits we can see very clear how his style and way of representing the human figure changes through out the years.



Henry Matisse (1869-1954)

Henry Matisse's work is recognizable because of his amazing capacity for drawing, his ability to synthesize the shapes and his use of the color.



Egon Schiele (1890-1918)

Egon Schiele's paintings and drawings are very strong. They show expressions and feelings, and tell us a lot about himself.
He had a very characteristic way of representing the human body.
He created around 100 self portraits during his short life!.